

THE THIRD EDITION OF BLR HUBBA PROMISES **350-PLUS EVENTS** ACROSS A GAMUT OF CURATED SUB-FESTIVALS

FESTIVAL

HULLABALLOO IN THE GARDEN CITY

BLR Hubba, a 10-day cultural extravaganza, is all set to sweep Bengaluru

Bengaluru often hits the headlines for its IT parks, pub culture and jam-packed roads. However, from January 16-25, the city is all set to paint a different narrative as the third edition of BLR Hubba will take over its streets and cultural spaces. Organised by the collaborative platform UnboxingBLR, the 10-day celebration promises 350-plus events through a gamut of curated sub-festivals such as 'Thindi Hubba' (food), 'Kala Hubba' (visual arts), 'Makkala Hubba' (children) and 'Rasthe Hubba' (streets), among others.

The festival will unfold at over 30 venues from iconic cultural spaces like Freedom Park, Sabha, Panchavati, Bangalore International Centre, MAP and National Gallery of Modern Art to neighbourhood sites in areas like Sadashivanagar and Basavanagudi.

The idea for BLR Hubba took shape from a 2023 book project called 'Unboxing Bengaluru' by Malini Goyal and Prashanth Prakash. "Cities around the world actively document and celebrate their cultural legacy, but Bengaluru, as a fast-growing tech and migrant hub, is experienced very differently. It needed something more alive and participatory, which is what led to the 'habba'," says Malini, co-founder and CEO of UnboxingBLR.

By blending 'hub' and 'habba' (the Kannada word for festival), BLR Hubba reflects a city that is at once globally connected and joyfully rooted in local culture. "We were inspired by cities like Edinburgh, which has left an indelible imprint on the global map thanks to the Edinburgh Festival Fringe, one of the world's top arts festivals," says V. Ravichandar, chief facilitator of the event. He highlights Anubhava Hubba, an immersive programme of multi-sensory experiences curated by several artists.

BLR Hubba also promises a dazzling line-up of musical acts through Kantha Hubba. Drawing its name from the Bengali word 'Kantha', which refers to interwoven strands of fabric, this segment will celebrate

